DRIVER SEAT LOWER SEAT TRIM INSERT INSTALLATION

AFFECTED VEHICLES: CERTAIN 2002 MODEL YEAR THUNDERBIRD

OVERVIEW

This document details specifically the procedure for installing an insert plate onto the driver seat lower seat trim. Because there are no diagnostics performed and no restraint components disturbed, deactivation and reactivation of the supplemental restraint system is not required for this Safety Recall procedure.

For all other vehicle system diagnosis and repair that are not related to this Safety Recall procedure but could potentially affect restraint system deactivation (such as other seat or interior repairs or restraint system service), refer to and follow the approved Workshop Manual procedures.

NOTE: The procedure in this bulletin is not the same as the published workshop manual procedures that include removal of the seat cushion lower seat trim. Removal of the seat, disconnecting of the seat wiring harness and the supplemental restraints deactivation/reactivation is not necessary.

REMOVAL

1. Move the driver seat to its full forward position.
2. Record the radio preset stations and disconnect the battery negative cable.
3. **NOTE: Do not disconnect any electrical connectors while performing this procedure.**

   Using a suitable trim tool, use a twisting motion to remove the seat control switch knob. See Figure 1.

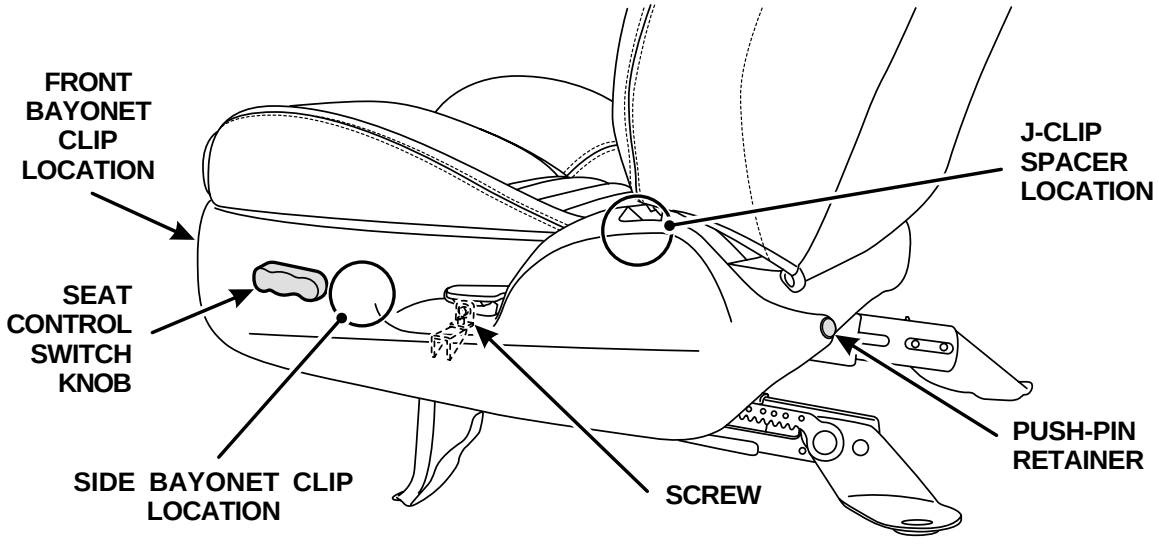


FIGURE 1

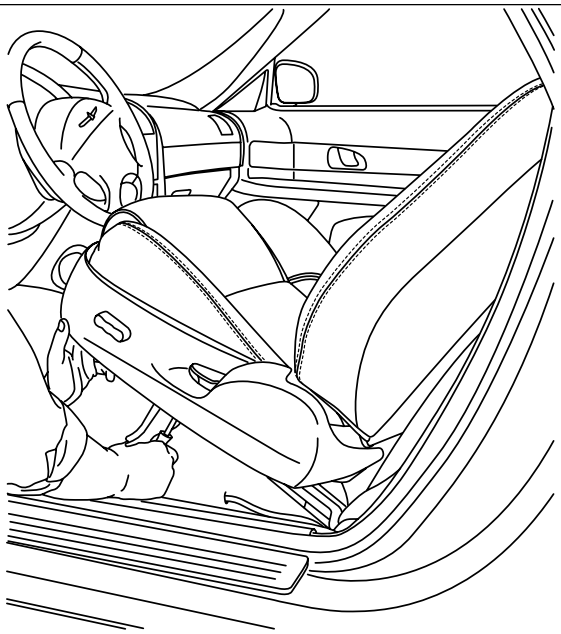
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4. **NOTE: Do not disconnect any electrical connectors while performing this procedure.**

   Remove the two (2) seat front mounting bolts and the two (2) seat rear mounting nuts from the seat.

5. **CAUTION: To avoid damage to any interior components, install protective covers as necessary.**

   Tilt the seat backward to access and remove the lower seat trim retaining screw. See Figure 2.



SEAT TILTED FOR ACCESS TO RETAINING SCREW **02S38B**

FIGURE 2

6. **CAUTION: Be careful not to damage the bayonet clips or their protective sleeves (if equipped) while removing the lower seat trim. Replacement parts are not available.**

   NOTE: The lower seat trim will have a J-clip installed, as a spacer, near the flap that is inserted between the seat back and the recliner mechanism. If this J-clip becomes dislodged during removal, make sure to install it back onto the lower seat trim before attaching the lower seat trim to the seat.

   Release the lower seat trim from the seat frame as follows. See Figure 1.

   a) Remove and discard the push-pin retainer.
   b) Disengage the side bayonet clip.
   c) Disengage the front bayonet clip.

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7. **NOTE: Do not disconnect any electrical connectors or the seat control switch wiring harness while performing this procedure.**

   Remove the seat control switch from the lower seat trim, then place the trim on a suitable work surface. See Figure 3.

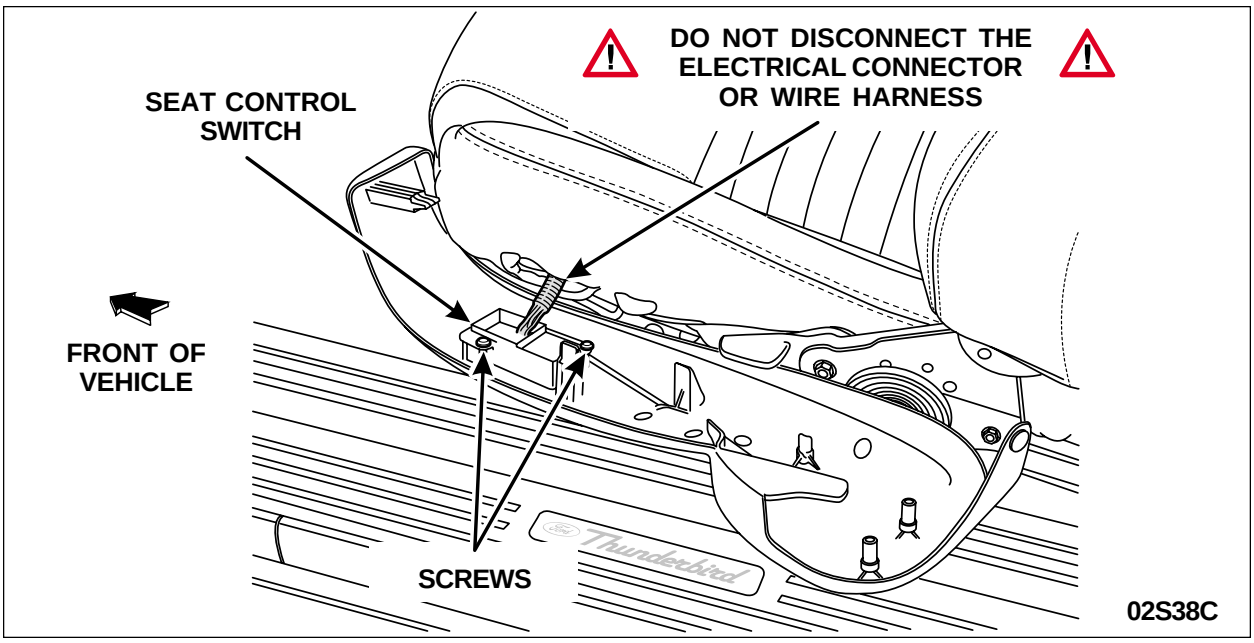


FIGURE 3

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INSTALLATION

1. NOTE: The driver seat lower seat trim insert has five (5) holes but will be held in place by only three (3) fasteners.

   Position the insert onto the lower seat trim and install the fasteners using a 14 mm deep well socket and driver handle. Be sure to fully seat the fasteners to secure the insert. Failure to fully seat the fasteners may cause the insert to rattle. See Figure 4.

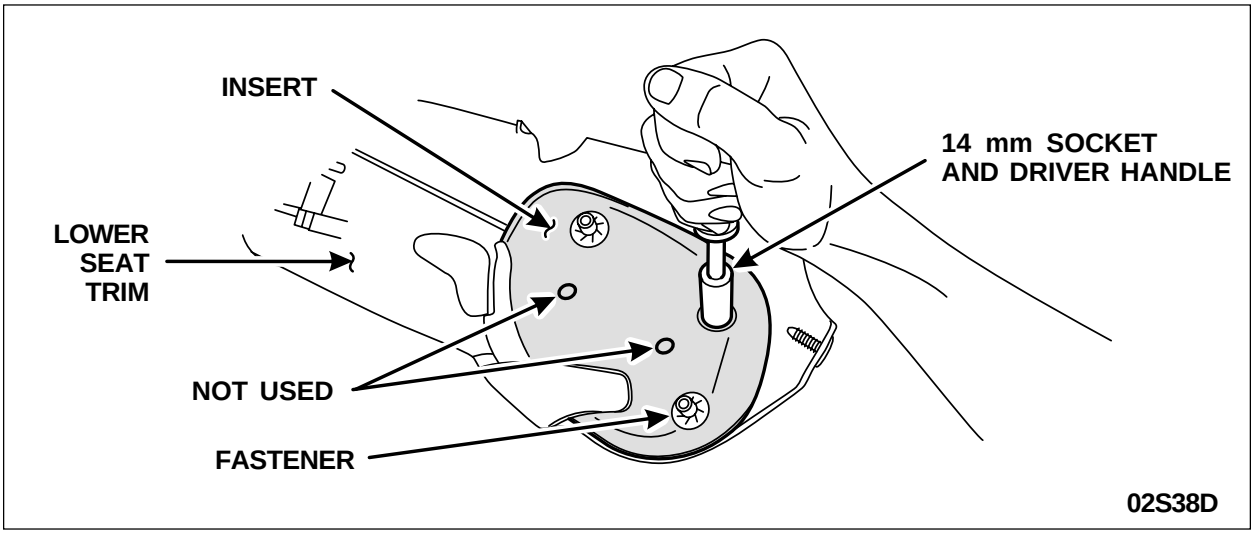


FIGURE 4

2. **NOTE: Do not disconnect any electrical connectors while performing this procedure.**

   Install the lower seat trim onto the seat frame as follows.

   a) Attach the seat control switch to the lower seat trim.

   b) Engage the front bayonet clip.

   c) Engage the side bayonet clip.

   d) Install a ***new*** push-pin retainer.

3. Tilt the seat backward and install the lower seat trim retaining screw.
4. Position the seat and install the two (2) seat front mounting bolts and the two (2) seat rear mounting nuts. Tighten all four (4) fasteners to 47 Nm (35 lb-ft).
5. Install the seat control switch knob.
6. Connect the battery negative cable and set the recorded radio stations.
7. Check seat operation. Make sure that the lower seat trim does not interfere with the seat track, seatback recliner handle, or seat control switch operation.

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